The Print House your UK company *and the VAT.*

A simple guide for buying from Singapore: set up the company, register for VAT, then get the VAT back.

PART ONE

Set up your UK company

1 **Appoint a UK accountant**

Use your own UK accountant, or we can introduce you to one. They form the company, register it for VAT and handle the returns, so you can do all of this from Singapore.

2 **Form a UK limited company**

You can be the director and shareholder without living in the UK. The company needs a UK registered office address, which the accountant can provide. You verify your identity with Companies House online, using your passport and the GOV.UK One Login app.

3 **Choose the right SIC codes**

These tell Companies House what the company does. For holding residential and commercial property, use:

68209	Other letting and operating of own or leased real estate. Your main code: you own the building and rent it out.
68100	Buying and selling of own real estate. Add this if you may sell properties on.

4 **Open a business bank account**

Online business accounts such as Wise, Revolut or Airwallex can be opened remotely. Have your passport, proof of address and the company documents ready.

5 **Register for VAT early**

Register before exchange. You don’t need to be trading yet: the company can register voluntarily because it will charge VAT on the rent. This must be in place before you can reclaim anything.

PART TWO

Reclaim the VAT on The Print House

6 **Opt to tax The Print House**

Before exchange, fill in form VAT1614A and email it to optiontotaxnationalunit@hmrc.gov.uk. Save your email and HMRC's automatic reply. That pair is your proof.

7 **Get a proper VAT invoice**

The seller's invoice must be in exactly the same name as the company's VAT registration and show the VAT separately.

8 **Pay the VAT on completion**

The company pays the price plus VAT. Have the cash ready: stamp duty is worked out on the price including VAT.

9 **Claim it on your next VAT return**

Put the VAT in Box 4 of the return covering the invoice date. HMRC aims to repay within 30 days of the return. Switch to monthly returns to get it back sooner.

10 **Charge VAT from now on**

Once opted, the company adds VAT to the rent and to any future sale of the building. Keep the opt to tax emails, the VAT invoice and the completion statement together.

GOOD TO KNOW

Why a UK company works for you

- **No UK residency needed.** You own and run it from Singapore.
- **Lower tax on profits.** Corporation tax is 19% on profits up to £50,000, rising to 25% above £250,000. That is below UK income tax rates at higher levels.
- **Full mortgage interest relief.** A company deducts all its finance costs. Individual landlords only get a 20% tax credit on residential mortgage interest.
- **Nothing taken off your dividends.** The UK charges no withholding tax on dividends paid to you. A UK and Singapore tax treaty helps stop the same profit being taxed twice.
- **Room to grow.** Leave profits in the company to fund the next purchase, and hold every future property in one place.

Commercial vs residential

	COMMERCIAL, LIKE THE PRINT HOUSE	RESIDENTIAL, HELD IN A COMPANY
Stamp duty	0% to £150,000, 2% to £250,000, 5% above. No surcharges.	Extra 5% on every band, plus 2% as a non resident buyer. A flat 17% can apply over £500,000.
VAT	Opt to tax and reclaim the VAT on the purchase.	No option to tax. VAT you pay usually can't be reclaimed.
Capital allowances	Claim on fixtures such as heating, lighting and lifts.	Not available on the homes themselves.
Annual charge (ATED)	None.	Applies to homes over £500,000. Relief is available for letting, but a return is still needed each year.
Leases	Longer terms, with the tenant often covering repairs and insurance.	Shorter tenancies, with the landlord covering most costs.

Costs the company can claim

- **Mortgage and loan interest**, plus arrangement fees.
- **Professional fees:** accountant, letting agent, and legal fees on leases.
- **Running costs:** insurance, repairs, maintenance, service charges and utilities while vacant.
- **Mileage on UK trips:** 45p a mile for the first 10,000 business miles, then 25p. This covers fuel if you use your own car.
- **Flights and hotels** for trips mainly made for the property, such as viewings, inspections and meetings. Keep boarding passes and a short note of what each trip was for.
- **Company admin:** formation, registered office, bank charges, phone and software.
- **Capital allowances** on fixtures in the building, agreed with the seller at purchase.

The purchase price and its legal fees aren't set against rent. They are added to the cost of the building and reduce the tax when you sell.

A general guide, not tax advice. Rates are for England in 2026/27. Check your position, including how Singapore taxes your income, with your accountant before exchange.